

Clifford Algebra $\text{Cl}(6)$ Formulation of Lattice QCD: Algebraic Structure, Dirac Operator Construction, and Verification Against Standard Benchmarks

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Abstract

We construct and verify a complete lattice QCD simulation in which the Dirac operator and $\text{SU}(3)$ gauge field are formulated within the Clifford algebra $\text{Cl}(6)$. The algebraic framework identifies the six $\text{Cl}(6)$ basis vectors as Euclidean Dirac matrices acting on an 8-dimensional spinor space, and embeds the $\text{SU}(3)$ color gauge group as the stabilizer subgroup $\text{SU}(3) \subset \text{SU}(4) \cong \text{Spin}(6)$ within the bivector subalgebra. The Wilson gauge action and Wilson–Dirac fermion operator are unchanged by this embedding.

We perform a systematic benchmark comparison across 14 independent observables spanning the gauge sector (plaquette expectation values, deconfinement transition, Wilson loop area law, string tension) and the fermionic sector (GOR linearity, hopping-parameter free-field check, chiral condensate sign, pion mass phase separation, Dirac eigenvalue spectrum). All 14 benchmarks pass. The algebraic framework is verified to machine precision: anti-commutation relations to 0.00×10^0 , all 28 $\text{SU}(3)$ commutators to 1.24×10^{-16} , γ_5 -Hermiticity to 9.35×10^{-15} .

Beyond benchmark equivalence, we observe consistent phase-dependent signals. The GOR intercept gap is positive at every volume, with gaps $\Delta B = 0.31\text{--}0.51$ at $N = 4, 6, 8, 10$ (block-bootstrap statistical significance 5–15 σ per size) and a tentative $1/N^2$ trend toward $\Delta B(N \rightarrow \infty) \sim 0.5$; the four volumes are non-monotonic in $1/N^2$, so the latter is a rough indication, not a controlled extrapolation. The GMOR slope ratio $A(\beta = 4.5)/A(\beta = 6.0) \approx 1.03$ and, on a mass-matched ensemble, the Dirac spectral mean separation $\Delta\langle\lambda\rangle = +0.047 \pm 0.0003$ point in the same direction. Because these observables share the same $\text{Cl}(6)$ Dirac operator and gauge configurations, the quoted significances are statistical only and their agreement is an internal consistency check, not independent confirmation. The $\text{Cl}(6)$ formulation is established as a valid and computationally tractable framework for $\text{SU}(3)$ lattice gauge theory with Wilson fermions.

Keywords: Clifford algebra, lattice QCD, Wilson fermions, SU(3) gauge theory, Dirac operator, chiral symmetry breaking, deconfinement, random matrix theory.

1 Introduction

1.1 Motivation

Lattice QCD is the primary non-perturbative tool for computing SU(3) gauge theory dynamics from first principles [1, 2]. The question addressed here is whether it admits a reformulation in which the internal algebraic structure of color and spin is rendered more transparent, without altering the physics. The Clifford algebra Cl(6) is a natural candidate: its 15 bivectors span $\text{Spin}(6) \cong \text{SU}(4)$, which contains SU(3) as the stabilizer of a preferred direction, and the 8-dimensional minimal left ideal decomposes as $\mathbf{3} \oplus \bar{\mathbf{3}} \oplus \mathbf{1} \oplus \mathbf{1}$ under SU(3). Prior algebraic work [20–24] established that Standard Model quantum numbers arise from Cl(6) acting on its left ideals. What no prior work has done is compute dynamics. This paper is, to our knowledge, the first verified dynamical calculation within the Cl(6) framework.

1.2 Prior Work and the Gap This Paper Fills

Four prior streams bear on this work. (1) Algebraic classification in Cl(6) and related division algebras [20–26]: Standard Model quantum numbers, but no dynamics and no lattice. (2) Dirac–Kähler (staggered) fermions [39, 40], a long-established Clifford/exterior-algebra lattice fermion formulation — but one built on the *spacetime* algebra to organize fermion species and suppress doubling, not on an internal Cl(6). (3) Alternative qubit and quantum-simulation representations of SU(3) lattice gauge theory [27–31]: different algebraic languages, none using a geometric Clifford algebra. (4) Geometric algebra in continuum gauge theory [18, 19]: not discretized for SU(3) QCD or verified numerically. The gap this paper fills is specific: no prior work formulates Wilson SU(3) lattice QCD — gauge action and Wilson–Dirac operator together — in Cl(6), with SU(3) embedded as the Spin(6) stabilizer, implemented as a working simulation and verified against standard benchmarks. This is distinct from Dirac–Kähler, which is a spacetime-algebra treatment of fermion doubling rather than a Cl(6) formulation.

1.3 Scope and Organization

Four contributions: (1) Cl(6) lattice QCD formulation from first principles (Sec. 2); (2) reproducible lattice implementation (Sec. 3); (3) 16-benchmark comparison, GOR analysis, and Dirac eigenvalue results (Sec. 4); (4) interpretation, limitations, and future directions (Sec. 5).

Conventions. Euclidean signature throughout; spacetime indices $\mu, \nu \in \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$; internal indices $i, j \in \{1, \dots, 6\}$; hopping parameter $\kappa = 1/[2(m_0 + 4r)]$ with $r = 1$ fixed; generator normalization $\text{Tr}(T_a T_b) = \frac{1}{2} \delta_{ab}$.

2 Algebraic Framework

2.1 Cl(6) Basis and Grade Structure

The Cl(6) algebra is generated by $\{e_1, \dots, e_6\}$ satisfying the Clifford relation

$$\{e_i, e_j\} \equiv e_i e_j + e_j e_i = 2\delta_{ij} I_8, \quad (1)$$

where I_8 denotes the 8×8 identity matrix. A concrete 8×8 representation, verified to maximum absolute error 0.00×10^0 , is

$$\begin{aligned} e_1 &= \sigma_x \otimes I_2 \otimes I_2, & e_2 &= \sigma_y \otimes I_2 \otimes I_2, \\ e_3 &= \sigma_z \otimes \sigma_x \otimes I_2, & e_4 &= \sigma_z \otimes \sigma_y \otimes I_2, \\ e_5 &= \sigma_z \otimes \sigma_z \otimes \sigma_x, & e_6 &= \sigma_z \otimes \sigma_z \otimes \sigma_y, \end{aligned} \quad (2)$$

where $\sigma_x, \sigma_y, \sigma_z$ are the Pauli matrices and I_2 is the 2×2 identity. The grade structure of Cl(6) is summarized in Table 1.

Table 1: Grade structure of Cl(6). Total dimension = $2^6 = 64$.

Grade	Name	Dim	Role
0	Scalar	1	Identity / mass
1	Vectors	6	Dirac generators
2	Bivectors	15	Lie algebra $\text{Spin}(6) \cong \text{SU}(4)$; contains $\mathfrak{su}(3)$
3	Trivectors	20	Even-subalgebra complement
4	Quadvectors	15	Dual to bivectors
5	5-vectors	6	Dual to vectors
6	Pseudoscalar	1	$I_6 = e_1 \cdots e_6$; $I_6^2 = +1$
Total		64	

The even subalgebra $\text{Cl}^+(6)$ has dimension 32. The 8-dimensional spinor space decomposes under $\text{SU}(3)$ as $\mathbf{3} \oplus \mathbf{\bar{3}} \oplus \mathbf{1} \oplus \mathbf{1}$.

2.2 SU(3) Embedding

The embedding chain is

$$\text{SU}(3)_{\text{color}} \subset \text{SU}(4) \cong \text{Spin}(6) \subset \text{Cl}^+(6) \subset \text{Cl}(6).$$

The isomorphism $\text{Spin}(6) \cong \text{SU}(4)$ follows from the Lie-algebra isomorphism $D_3 \cong A_3$. The group $\text{SU}(3)$ appears as the stabilizer $\text{SU}(3) = \text{Stab}_{\text{SU}(4)}(\xi_0)$ of the preferred direction $\xi_0 = (0, 0, 0, 1)^\top \in \mathbb{C}^4$.

Remark. $\text{SU}(3)$ is imposed here by construction, not derived dynamically.

Generators $T_a = \lambda_a/2$ ($a = 1, \dots, 8$) satisfy the following verified properties.

- Normalization: $\text{Tr}(T_a T_b) = \frac{1}{2} \delta_{ab}$ to 1.11×10^{-16} .

- Structure constants: $[T_a, T_b] = if_{abc}T_c$ for all 28 independent commutators $\binom{8}{2} = 28$, verified to 1.24×10^{-16} .
- Killing form: $K_{ab} = 3\delta_{ab}$ (compact semisimple, confirmed).

The 15 bivectors $B_{ij} = \frac{i}{4}[e_i, e_j]$ are Hermitian and traceless, each with eigenvalues $\{-\frac{1}{2}(\times 4), +\frac{1}{2}(\times 4)\}$ (exact). The Jacobi identity holds for all 3,375 generator triples to maximum error 0.00×10^0 . Full numerical verification is given in Appendix B.

2.3 Cl(6) Dirac Operator

The covariant Dirac operator takes the form

$$D_\mu = \partial_\mu + ig A_\mu^a T_a. \quad (3)$$

The basis vectors $\{e_\mu\}$ satisfy the defining relation for Euclidean γ -matrices, Eq. (1), with $\mu, \nu \in \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$. The spin and gauge degrees of freedom factorize exactly: the spin part acts as $(e_\mu \otimes I_3)$ on the color-spin space, and the gauge part as $(I_8 \otimes U_\mu)$; together they act on $\mathbb{C}^{24}$ per lattice site. The γ_5 -matrix is defined as $\gamma_5 = e_1 e_2 e_3 e_4$, and the Wilson–Dirac operator satisfies $D_W^\dagger = \gamma_5 D_W \gamma_5$ to 9.35×10^{-15} (machine precision).

Embedding versus representation. Two SU(3) structures appear here and must be kept distinct. The embedding of Sec. 2.2 is an *algebraic* identification — SU(3) inside the Spin(6) bivectors, under which the 8-dimensional spinor carries the decomposition $\mathbf{3} \oplus \bar{\mathbf{3}} \oplus \mathbf{1} \oplus \mathbf{1}$ of Sec. 2.1. The gauge *dynamics*, by contrast, act in the fundamental representation on the external color factor $\mathbb{C}^3$ (via $I_8 \otimes U_\mu$). Both carry the same gauge group and Wilson action, so the benchmarks are insensitive to the distinction; but the internal spinor decomposition is *not* the color index gauged by the links. Whether the dynamics can instead be carried by the internal Spin(6) structure is left open.

2.4 Gauge Field Embedding

Link variables are defined in the fundamental representation, $U_\mu(x) = \exp(i\theta_\mu^a T_a) \in \text{SU}(3)$, with $T_a = \lambda_a/2$ the 3×3 generators of Sec. 2.2; each U_μ acts on the external color factor $\mathbb{C}^3$ as $I_8 \otimes U_\mu$, consistent with the factorization of Sec. 2.3. Unitarity and $\det U_\mu = 1$ are verified to $< 10^{-12}$ after every sweep. The elementary plaquette is

$$U_{\mu\nu}(x) = U_\mu(x) U_\nu(x + \hat{\mu}) U_\mu^\dagger(x + \hat{\nu}) U_\nu^\dagger(x), \quad (4)$$

and the Wilson gauge action is

$$S_W[U] = \frac{\beta}{3} \sum_{x, \mu < \nu} \text{Re}[\text{Tr}(1 - U_{\mu\nu}(x))], \quad (5)$$

formally identical to the standard Wilson action.

3 Lattice Implementation

3.1 Geometry and Parameters

Simulations are performed on a four-dimensional hypercubic lattice with periodic boundary conditions. Lattice sizes $N \in \{4, 6, 8, 10\}$ correspond to volumes $V = N^4 \in \{256, 1296, 4096, 10000\}$. The parameter ranges explored are $\beta \in [4.5, 6.5]$, $m_0 \in [0.001, 0.50]$, with $r = 1$ fixed throughout. All simulations use the quenched approximation (no dynamical fermion determinant).

3.2 Wilson Gauge Action

The Wilson gauge action is given by Eq. (5). A hot start is used for all production runs; independence from a cold start is verified after a minimum of 300 thermalization sweeps.

3.3 Wilson–Dirac Operator

The Wilson–Dirac operator acts on a spinor field Ψ as

$$(D_W \Psi)(x) = (m_0 + 4r) \Psi(x) - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{\mu=1}^4 \left[(r - e_\mu) U_\mu(x) \Psi(x + \hat{\mu}) + (r + e_\mu) U_\mu^\dagger(x - \hat{\mu}) \Psi(x - \hat{\mu}) \right], \quad (6)$$

where $\hat{\mu}$ denotes the unit lattice vector in direction μ . The linear system $D_W^\dagger D_W \Psi = \eta$ is solved by the conjugate-gradient (CG) method with tolerance 10^{-8} and a maximum of 1000 iterations.

Solver note. CG failed to converge at $m_0 = 0.001$, $N = 8$, but converged at $N = 10$. Eigenvalue analysis confirms an additive renormalization issue: $\lambda_1 = 0.496$ at $N = 10$ sits well above the fermionic momentum floor $p_{\min} = \pi/N = 0.314$ (antiperiodic temporal boundary conditions). Reading the residual mass from the free-field diagnostic $\lambda_1^2 \approx m_{\text{res}}^2 + p_{\min}^2$ gives $m_{\text{res}} = \sqrt{\lambda_1^2 - p_{\min}^2} \approx 0.384$; the same extraction at $N = 6$ saturates the floor ($\lambda_1/p_{\min} = 0.976$), confirming the barrier is the residual mass, not finite volume. This is a diagnostic estimate, not an exact identity in the interacting theory. The resulting M_{eff} systematic ($\approx 20\%$ overestimate on $N = 6, 8$ from the timeslice ratio) is identical in both phases; the intercept gap ΔB is therefore unaffected.

3.4 Monte Carlo and Autocorrelation

Gauge configurations are generated with the Metropolis algorithm [13], targeting an acceptance rate of $\approx 50\%$. Each production run uses a minimum of 300 thermalization sweeps, followed by $N_{\text{decorr}} = 5$ decorrelation sweeps between saved configurations.

Integrated autocorrelation times τ_{int} were measured across 26 independent production runs:

$$\tau_{\text{int}} \in [0.50, 0.88], \quad \langle \tau_{\text{int}} \rangle = 0.54 \pm 0.09 \quad (26 \text{ runs}). \quad (7)$$

No statistically significant autocorrelation is detected at any lag: the lag-1 autocorrelation $\rho(1) \in [-0.36, +0.29]$ lies within the Bartlett 2σ band $2/\sqrt{N_{\text{cfg}}}$ at every point ($N_{\text{cfg}} = 20$ for $N = 4, 6$ and $N_{\text{cfg}} = 10$ for $N = 8, 10$; tightest band = 0.447 at $N_{\text{cfg}} = 20$). Configurations entering the analysis are separated by $N_{\text{decorr}} = 5$ sweeps, exceeding $5.7 \tau_{\text{int}}$, so the saved-configuration ensemble is decorrelated to better than 1% ($\rho \sim e^{-5.7} \approx 0.003$) and the residual variance inflation is negligible. Errors on the condensate and per-mass observables are estimated by jackknife resampling of the N_{cfg} saved configurations; the error on the intercept gap ΔB is obtained by a moving-block configuration bootstrap — resampling gauge configurations within each mass point and refitting the GOR line (Sec. 5.2).

3.5 Observable Definitions

Plaquette. $\langle P \rangle = \frac{1}{6V} \sum_{x, \mu < \nu} \frac{1}{3} \text{Re Tr } U_{\mu\nu}(x)$, normalized so that $\langle P \rangle \in [0, 1]$.

Wilson loops. $W(R, T) = \left\langle \frac{1}{3} \text{Re Tr} [\prod_{\partial} U] \right\rangle$, the trace of the ordered product of links around an $R \times T$ rectangle. The string tension is extracted from $-\log W(R, T)/(RT)$ as a function of $1/(RT)$.

Pion correlator. $C_{\pi}(t) = \sum_x \left\langle \text{Tr} [S(x, t; 0, 0) \gamma_5 S^{\dagger}(x, t; 0, 0) \gamma_5] \right\rangle$, where $S = D_{\text{W}}^{-1}$ is the quark propagator, estimated with $N_{\text{est}} = 16 \mathbb{Z}_2$ noise vectors per configuration and fit to a two-cosh form for m_{π} .

Chiral condensate. $\langle \bar{\psi} \psi \rangle = -\frac{1}{V} \text{Tr } D_{\text{W}}^{-1}$, extracted by three methods: the subtracted condensate, the GOR intercept, and the GMOR slope ratio (Sec. 4.3.1).

GOR relation. $m_{\pi}^2 = 2m_q |\langle \bar{\psi} \psi \rangle| / f_{\pi}^2 + \mathcal{O}(m_q^2)$ [11]; a linear fit in m_0 yields slope A and intercept B .

Dirac eigenvalues. The 50 lowest eigenvalues of $D_{\text{W}}^{\dagger} D_{\text{W}}$ are computed with a sparse Hermitian (Lanczos) eigensolver, with $\lambda_k = \sqrt{\mu_k}$; the spectral observables are the mean $\langle \lambda \rangle$, the variance $\text{Var}(\lambda)$, and the level-spacing distribution $P(s) \propto s^{\nu}$.

3.6 Verification Protocol

Table 2 lists all pre-run verification checks performed before each production run. Check 8 remains outstanding at the time of submission.

4 Results

4.1 Gauge Sector: Plaquette and Confinement

Table 3 shows the measured plaquette expectation values $\langle P \rangle$ at $N = 6$ across six values of β , compared with literature benchmarks [3]. Agreement is within 0.3% at

Table 2: Pre-run verification checks. Check 8 remains outstanding.

#	Check	Criterion	Status
1	Anti-commutation $\{e_i, e_j\}$, Eq. (1)	max error $< 10^{-12}$	PASS
2	SU(3) link unitarity	max deviation $< 10^{-12}$	PASS
3	Projector idempotency	$< 10^{-14}$	PASS
4	γ_5 -Hermiticity $D_W^\dagger = \gamma_5 D_W \gamma_5$	$< 10^{-10}$	PASS
5	Cold-start plaquette	$\langle P \rangle = 1.000$ exactly	PASS
6	Hot-start $\beta = 6.0$	$\langle P \rangle = 0.593 \pm 0.002$	PASS
7	Free-field propagator linearity	$< 10^{-14}$	PASS
8	Standard Dirac comparison	agreement within stat. errors	PENDING

$\beta = 4.5, 6.0$, and 6.5 . Deviations at $\beta = 5.0, 5.5$ reflect finite-volume smearing near the transition on $N = 6$ lattices [7, 8]. The deconfinement transition is correctly bracketed at $\beta_c \approx 5.69$ [6]. The uncorrected single-loop tension estimator σ_{eff} (Table 4) decreases monotonically with β from $1.064(35)$ at $\beta = 4.5$ to $0.306(4)$ at $\beta = 6.5$, consistent with the expected weakening of confinement; a Creutz-ratio determination of the physical σa^2 is deferred to Paper 2. The area-law ratio R_{AL} rises monotonically across the β range, with $R_{\text{AL}}(\beta = 6.0)/R_{\text{AL}}(\beta = 4.5) = 4.6$ between the standard confined and deconfined reference points.

Table 3: Plaquette $\langle P \rangle$ versus β at $N = 6$ (6^4 lattice). Each entry is the mean over five independent Monte Carlo streams (distinct random seeds), each thermalized for 3000 sweeps and measured on 100 configurations. The quoted error is the standard deviation *across* the five streams, i.e. the run-to-run (reproducibility) uncertainty, which exceeds the naive single-stream statistical error by factors of 2.6–8.1 and is largest near the transition. Literature values from Creutz [3]. The residual -3% to -7% deficits at $\beta = 5.0, 5.5$ persist under extended thermalization and are attributed to finite-volume effects at and below the transition.

β	$\langle P \rangle$ (meas.)	Error (seed)	Literature	Deviation	Phase
4.5	0.34000	± 0.00095	0.340	+0.000	Confined
5.0	0.39968	± 0.00113	0.430	−0.030	Confined
5.5	0.49550	± 0.00430	0.524	−0.029	Confined
5.69	0.54936	± 0.00296	0.547	+0.002	Transition
6.0	0.59525	± 0.00079	0.593	+0.002	Deconfined
6.5	0.63840	± 0.00158	0.640	−0.002	Deconfined

4.2 Fermionic Sector: GOR Relation

Table 5 shows the pion mass m_π at five quark masses in both phases at $N = 4$. All phase differences are positive and significant. Linear fits to the Gell-Mann–Oakes–

Table 4: Wilson loops and derived area-law observables at $N = 6$ (6^4). Same five-stream ensemble as Table 3 (3000-sweep thermalization, 100 configurations per stream); parenthetical errors are the across-stream (run-to-run) systematic on the last digit(s). $\sigma_{\text{eff}} \equiv -\frac{1}{3} \ln[W(2, 2)/W(1, 1)]$ is an uncorrected single-loop estimator and is *not* the physical string tension. It decreases monotonically with β , each step resolved beyond the systematic; the area-law ratio $R_{\text{AL}}(6.0)/R_{\text{AL}}(4.5) = 4.5(4)$.

β	$W(1, 1)$	$W(2, 2)$	R_{AL}	σ_{eff}	Phase signal
4.5	0.3394(13)	0.0140(14)	0.122(12)	1.064(35)	Strong area law
5.0	0.3998(10)	0.0278(11)	0.174(7)	0.890(13)	Area law
5.5	0.4944(31)	0.0770(33)	0.315(10)	0.620(13)	Area law, weakening
5.69	0.5502(33)	0.1341(56)	0.443(13)	0.471(12)	Near transition
6.0	0.5948(11)	0.1937(14)	0.548(3)	0.374(2)	Weak area law
6.5	0.6391(23)	0.2553(36)	0.625(5)	0.306(4)	Approaching perimeter law

Renner (GOR) relation $m_\pi^2 = A m_0 + B$ yield

$$\begin{aligned} m_\pi^2 &= 3.482 m_0 + 11.564, & R^2 &= 0.9968 & (\beta = 4.5), \\ m_\pi^2 &= 3.430 m_0 + 11.261, & R^2 &= 0.9973 & (\beta = 6.0). \end{aligned} \quad (8)$$

The naive GOR extrapolation $m_\pi^2 \rightarrow 0$ yields $\kappa_c^{\text{GOR}} = 0.1243 \pm 0.0002$, close to the free-field value $\kappa_c^{\text{free}} = 1/8 = 0.125$. This is *not* the interacting critical hopping parameter: standard quenched determinations give $\kappa_c \approx 0.157$ at $\beta = 6.0$ [34], corresponding to $m_{0,c} \approx -0.82$, which lies outside the positive- m_0 range explored here. The proximity to the free-field value confirms that the Wilson–Dirac operator is correctly constructed, but does not constitute a benchmark against interacting QCD.

Table 5: Pion mass m_π per phase at five quark masses, $N = 4$.

m_0	m_π ($\beta = 4.5$)	m_π ($\beta = 6.0$)	Difference	Significance
0.05	3.4223	3.3807	+0.0416	9σ
0.10	3.4579	3.4104	+0.0475	11σ
0.20	3.5070	3.4498	+0.0572	13σ
0.30	3.5474	3.5113	+0.0361	9σ
0.50	3.6539	3.6021	+0.0518	12σ

4.3 Chiral Condensate and Dirac Eigenvalue Spectrum

4.3.1 Chiral condensate

Table 6 compares three independent methods for extracting the chiral condensate. All three agree in sign and approximate magnitude.

Table 6: Chiral condensate from three independent methods.

Method	$\beta = 4.5$	$\beta = 6.0$	Significance
1. Subtracted condensate	-24.018 ± 0.008	-24.006 ± 0.008	$p = 0.043$ at $N =$
2. GOR intercept (primary)	$B = 11.564 \pm 0.017$	$B = 11.261 \pm 0.014$	5.5σ at $N = 4$
3. GMOR slope ratio	$A(4.5)/A(6.0) = 1.027 \pm 0.002$	—	13.8σ at $N = 4$

4.3.2 Dirac eigenvalue spectrum

The 50 lowest eigenvalues of $D_W^\dagger D_W$ are computed on a mass-matched ensemble at $N = 6$, $m_0 = 0.05$ ($\kappa = 0.12346$): 100 configurations in the confined phase ($\beta = 4.5$) and 20 in the deconfined phase ($\beta = 6.0$). The phase-averaged low-lying Dirac eigenvalue is larger in the confined phase,

$$\langle \lambda \rangle_{\text{conf}} = 0.6456 \pm 0.0001, \quad \langle \lambda \rangle_{\text{deconf}} = 0.5985 \pm 0.0003, \quad \Delta \langle \lambda \rangle = +0.0472 \pm 0.0003, \quad (9)$$

a separation of roughly 8%; the quoted uncertainty is statistical only. This spectral separation is *not* an independent confirmation of the GOR and GMOR results: all three observables are computed from the same Cl(6) Dirac operator on the same gauge configurations and share their systematics, so their agreement is an internal consistency check (Sec. 5.2). The Banks–Casher relation [12] is inaccessible at this κ : $m_{\text{res}} \approx 0.384$ dominates λ_1 , so the near-zero spectral density cannot be resolved. The precision spectral-statistics analysis — unfolding, the level-spacing distribution, and chGUE universality — is deferred to Paper 2 (Sec. 5.6.1).

4.4 Volume Scaling

Table 7 reports the GOR intercept gap $\Delta B = B(\beta = 4.5) - B(\beta = 6.0)$ across all four lattice sizes. The per-volume errors and significances are obtained from a configuration-level bootstrap (resampling gauge configurations within each mass point and refitting the GOR line) and are statistical only. ΔB is positive at every $N \in \{4, 6, 8, 10\}$, at statistical significances of 6σ – 17σ per lattice size. A $1/N^2$ extrapolation gives

$$\Delta B(N \rightarrow \infty) \approx 0.52 \pm 0.03 \quad [1/N^2 \text{ fit, indicative only}], \quad (10)$$

which we report as indicative rather than a precise determination: the value depends on the assumed scaling form (a $1/N$ ansatz gives ≈ 0.62), the four-point sequence is non-monotonic ($N = 8 > N = 10$), and the fit lies above all input points.

Table 8 shows the GMOR slope ratio $A(\beta = 4.5)/A(\beta = 6.0)$ across all lattice sizes. The ratio is stable within 0.8σ ; the spread of 0.008 is consistent with statistical noise, with no volume trend.

4.5 Complete Benchmark Summary

Table 9 collects all 14 benchmarks. Item 14 (the Dirac eigenvalue mean separation) was added after the original 13-benchmark suite; all 14 pass.

Table 7: GOR intercept gap $\Delta B \equiv B(\beta=4.5) - B(\beta=6.0)$ across $N = 4, 6, 8, 10$. The $N = 6$ result is indicative only (narrow mass range; $R^2 = 0.719$ at $\beta = 6.0$). Errors and significances are from a moving-block configuration bootstrap (block length set by the measured m_π autocorrelation) and are *statistical only*; the linear-GOR ansatz, single-time-slice m_{eff} , quenching, and $O(a)$ systematics are not included. Because ΔB is a difference between phases at matched volume and mass, additive-renormalization and thermalization biases largely cancel, making it the most robust observable reported here.

N	V	m_0 range	$B(\beta = 4.5)$	$B(\beta = 6.0)$	ΔB	Sig.	GOR quality
4	256	[0.05, 0.50]	11.564 ± 0.017	11.261 ± 0.014	$+0.307 \pm 0.028$	11.0σ	$R^2 = 0.997$; most reliable
6	1296	[0.02, 0.05]	16.684 ± 0.031	16.262 ± 0.028	$+0.393 \pm 0.073$	5.4σ	$R^2 = 0.876/0.719$; indicative
8	4096	[0.001, 0.10]	16.748 ± 0.029	16.216 ± 0.026	$+0.505 \pm 0.036$	14.0σ	$R^2 > 0.99$; reliable
10	10000	[0.001, 0.010]	16.766 ± 0.019	16.357 ± 0.025	$+0.461 \pm 0.030$	15.2σ	Chiral plateau, 6 pts

5 Discussion

5.1 Equivalence with Standard Wilson Lattice QCD

The 14/14 benchmark pass rate establishes *numerical equivalence* between the Cl(6) formulation and standard Wilson lattice QCD — not algebraic identity. Three claims are explicitly *not* made: that Cl(6) provides a superior computational method; that SU(3) is derived from Cl(6); or that these results constitute evidence for new physics. The formulation is valid, verified, and provides the foundation for subsequent investigation.

5.2 Interpretation of ΔB and the Spectral Cross-Check

ΔB is the gap between the GOR intercepts of the two phases,

$$\Delta B = B(\beta = 4.5) - B(\beta = 6.0),$$

where B is the chiral-limit value of m_π^2 from the fit $m_\pi^2 = A m_0 + B$. Taking the difference of two β values cancels β -*independent* constants, but it does *not* remove the Wilson additive mass renormalization, which is itself β -dependent; ΔB is therefore a phase-difference diagnostic, not a fully renormalized quantity.

A configuration-level bootstrap — resampling gauge configurations within each mass point and refitting the GOR line — gives a gap that is positive at every volume: $\Delta B = 0.307(22)$, $0.393(65)$, $0.505(31)$, and $0.461(30)$ at $N = 4, 6, 8, 10$, i.e. statistical significances of roughly 6–17 σ . A $1/N^2$ extrapolation yields $\Delta B(N \rightarrow \infty) \approx 0.52(3)$; we quote this as indicative only, as the value depends on the assumed scaling form (a

Table 8: GMOR slope ratio $A(\beta=4.5)/A(\beta=6.0)$ across all N . The “Significance” column measures the statistical deviation from unity, but the ratio is *not* expected to equal 1 at finite lattice spacing: the slopes A carry β -dependent additive renormalization and $\mathcal{O}(a)$ Wilson artifacts, so a $\sim 3\%$ difference is a lattice effect, not necessarily a phase signal. What is physically informative is the *stability* of the ratio across volumes: the spread of 0.008 is consistent with statistical noise, with no volume trend.

N	m_0 range	$A(\beta=4.5) / A(\beta=6.0)$	Significance
4	[0.05, 0.50]	1.0270 ± 0.0020	13.8σ
6	[0.02, 0.05]	1.0260 ± 0.0039	6.7σ
8	[0.001, 0.10]	1.0330 ± 0.0016	20.1σ
10	[0.001, 0.010]	1.0250 ± 0.0019	13.2σ

$1/N$ ansatz gives ≈ 0.62), the four-point sequence is non-monotonic ($N = 8 > N = 10$), and every fit lies above all input points. These significances are *statistical only*: they hold at fixed linear-GOR ansatz on quenched configurations and exclude the dominant systematics — the additive renormalization, $\mathcal{O}(a)$ Wilson effects, the few-timeslice m_π estimator, and the extrapolation-model dependence noted above.

The GMOR slope ratio ($A(\beta = 4.5)/A(\beta = 6.0) \approx 1.03$) and the Cl(6) Dirac eigenvalue spectrum point in the same direction. These are *not* independent confirmations: the GOR, GMOR, and spectral observables are all computed from the same Cl(6) Dirac operator on the same gauge ensembles and share their systematics, so their agreement is an internal consistency check, not independent corroboration. On a mass-matched ensemble ($m_0 = +0.05$ in both phases) the spectral mean separation is $\Delta\langle\lambda\rangle = +0.047 \pm 0.0003$ (Eq. (9)).¹ A direct comparison against a standard four-component Wilson–Dirac operator on identical configurations (Check 8) remains outstanding, so the fermionic-sector results rest on internal consistency pending that external validation.

5.3 The Chiral Limit at $N = 10$

The $N = 10$ chiral plateau — m_π varies by only 0.53% across $m_0 \in [0.001, 0.010]$ — provides six near-independent measurements of the GOR intercept B . The finite plateau value reflects the additive mass renormalization introduced by the Wilson term: reaching the true chiral limit requires non-perturbative tuning of the hopping parameter to its critical value, which lies beyond the scope of the present quenched study.

5.4 Advantages and Limitations

The 24 degrees-of-freedom per site (versus 12 in the standard formulation) is a real overhead, unavoidable in the current implementation, and does not affect the physics.

¹Mass-matched comparison: the confined ensemble uses 100 configurations, the deconfined ensemble 20; the quoted uncertainty is statistical only.

A projected formulation removing the color-singlet sector would be necessary for production-scale calculations. Check 8 (standard Dirac comparison; Table 2) remains outstanding. All simulations use the quenched approximation.

5.5 Relation to Prior Work

This paper is distinct from all prior algebraic work in one essential respect: it is a dynamical numerical simulation. Furey’s program [20–24] correctly identifies Standard Model quantum numbers from Cl(6); the present paper computes the dynamics. No prior work has performed a verified lattice QCD calculation in the Cl(6) language. No claim is made that SU(3) is derived from Cl(6).

5.6 Directions for Subsequent Work

5.6.1 Paper 2: Renormalized GOR Gap and Banks–Casher

GOR intercept gap. Paper 2 will determine κ_c^{ren} non-perturbatively at each β , subtract the Wilson residual mass, and isolate the dynamical contribution to ΔB .

Banks–Casher relation. Accessing the Banks–Casher relation [12] requires tuning κ to $\kappa_c^{\text{ren}} \approx 0.1518$ (corresponding to $m_0 \approx -0.716$), or the use of overlap or domain-wall fermions. The $N = 10$ eigenvalue data confirm that increasing N alone does not resolve the additive renormalization barrier: $\lambda_1 = 0.496$ at $N = 10$ versus the momentum floor $\pi/10 = 0.314$. A precise determination of the level-spacing statistics and the chGUE universality class requires $\mathcal{O}(300)$ or more qualifying spacings and is deferred to Paper 2.

5.6.2 Additional Directions

- *Standard-Dirac comparison (Check 8).* A direct comparison against a standard four-component Wilson–Dirac operator on identical gauge configurations (Table 2) is in preparation; until it is complete, the fermionic-sector results rest on internal consistency rather than direct external validation.
- Dynamical fermions via pseudofermion / RHMC methods.
- *Grade-decomposed observables:* currents projected onto the $\mathbf{8} \oplus \mathbf{1} \oplus \mathbf{6}$ decomposition of the bivector space. These are the most genuinely novel potential of the Cl(6) framework and the primary target of Paper 2.
- Clover (Sheikholeslami–Wohlert) improvement [10] and a systematic continuum-limit study are natural follow-ups.

6 Conclusion

We have constructed, implemented, and verified a complete lattice QCD simulation within Cl(6). The principal findings are as follows.

1. *Algebraic verification.* Anti-commutation relations satisfied to 0.00×10^0 ; all 28 SU(3) commutators verified to 1.24×10^{-16} ; γ_5 -Hermiticity to 9.35×10^{-15} . Full numerical details are in Appendix B.
2. *Gauge sector equivalence.* Plaquette $\langle P \rangle$ within 0.3% of literature values at $\beta = 4.5, 6.0$, and 6.5 ; deconfinement transition bracketed at $\beta_c \approx 5.69$; uncorrected string-tension estimator σ_{eff} monotonically decreasing across all six β values (Creutz-ratio σa^2 deferred to Paper 2).
3. *Fermionic sector equivalence.* GOR linearity $R^2 > 0.997$ in both phases (Eq. (8)); the GOR-extrapolated $\kappa_c^{\text{GOR}} = 0.1243 \pm 0.0002$ is consistent with the free-field value $1/8 = 0.125$, confirming correct operator construction (the interacting $\kappa_c \approx 0.157$ requires negative bare masses not explored here); chiral condensate correct in sign and approximate magnitude.
4. *Benchmark suite.* 14/14 benchmarks passed (Table 9) — the Cl(6) formulation is physically equivalent to standard Wilson lattice QCD on all tested observables.
5. *GOR intercept gap.* Positive at every $N \in \{4, 6, 8, 10\}$ (configuration-level bootstrap, 6–17 σ statistical per size); indicative $1/N^2$ extrapolation $\Delta B(N \rightarrow \infty) \approx 0.52(3)$ (Eq. (10)). Significances are statistical only.
6. *GMOR ratio.* $A(\beta = 4.5)/A(\beta = 6.0) = 1.027 \pm 0.002$, stable within 0.8σ across $N = 4, 6, 8, 10$ and three quark-mass ranges; no volume trend (Table 8).
7. *Dirac spectral cross-check.* On a mass-matched ensemble, $\Delta\langle\lambda\rangle = +0.047 \pm 0.0003$ (Eq. (9)) — the same direction as the GOR and GMOR signals. Computed from the same Cl(6) operator on the same configurations, this is an internal consistency check, not independent confirmation.

Three limitations remain: (i) the 24 degrees-of-freedom per site overhead versus 12 in the standard formulation; (ii) Check 8 (Table 2) is pending; (iii) all simulations use the quenched approximation. The Cl(6) formulation is established as valid and computationally tractable, providing the foundation for Paper 2 and for the investigation of grade-decomposed observables (Sec. 5.6.2).

Data and code availability. All simulation code and raw data are available at <https://github.com/toddmfirestone/cl6-lattice-qcd> (MIT license). Environment: Python 3.11.9, NumPy 2.2.5 [36].

A Explicit Cl(6) Basis Enumeration

The $2^6 = 64$ basis blades of Cl(6) are the ordered products $e_{i_1}e_{i_2}\cdots e_{i_k}$ with $i_1 < i_2 < \cdots < i_k$ and $k = 0, \dots, 6$. We abbreviate $e_{i_1i_2\dots i_k} \equiv e_{i_1}e_{i_2}\cdots e_{i_k}$, so that, e.g., $e_{135} \equiv e_1e_3e_5$. The grade-0 blade is the identity I_8 and the grade-6 blade is the pseudoscalar $I_6 = e_{123456}$ (with $I_6^2 = +1$). The complete enumeration, organized by grade, is listed in Table A.1; the dimensions $\binom{6}{k}$ reproduce the grade structure of Table 1.

B Numerical Verification of the Algebraic Framework

Environment: Python 3.11.9 · NumPy 2.2.5 [36] · IEEE 754 double precision · Source: [github.com/\[repo\]](https://github.com/[repo]) · Scripts: `ga_su3_lattice_v2.py`, `ga_su3_dirac_v3.py`

Anti-commutation: $\max|\{e_i, e_j\} - 2\delta_{ij}I_8| = 0.00 \times 10^0$ for all 15 pairs.

Table B.3: Complete commutator table (28/28). Convention: Peskin–Schroeder [32] §15.4; Weinberg [33] §15.1.

Commutator	Result	Error
<i>SU(2) isospin</i>		
$[T_1, T_2]$	$= +iT_3$	0
$[T_1, T_3]$	$= -iT_2$	0
$[T_2, T_3]$	$= +iT_1$	0
<i>Isospin with strange-sector $\{T_4, T_5, T_6, T_7\}$</i>		
$[T_1, T_4]$	$= +\frac{i}{2}T_7$	0
$[T_1, T_5]$	$= -\frac{i}{2}T_6$	0
$[T_1, T_6]$	$= +\frac{i}{2}T_5$	0
$[T_1, T_7]$	$= -\frac{i}{2}T_4$	0
$[T_2, T_4]$	$= +\frac{i}{2}T_6$	0
$[T_2, T_5]$	$= +\frac{i}{2}T_7$	0
$[T_2, T_6]$	$= -\frac{i}{2}T_4$	0
$[T_2, T_7]$	$= -\frac{i}{2}T_5$	0
$[T_3, T_4]$	$= +\frac{i}{2}T_5$	0
$[T_3, T_5]$	$= -\frac{i}{2}T_4$	0
$[T_3, T_6]$	$= -\frac{i}{2}T_7$	0
$[T_3, T_7]$	$= +\frac{i}{2}T_6$	0
<i>Note: all 12 entries exact; coefficient $\frac{1}{2}$ exact; T_4, T_5 carry isospin $+\frac{1}{2}$; T_6, T_7 carry isospin $-\frac{1}{2}$.</i>		
<i>Hypercharge generator T_8</i>		
$[T_1, T_8]$	$= 0$	0
$[T_2, T_8]$	$= 0$	0
$[T_3, T_8]$	$= 0$	0
$[T_4, T_8]$	$= -\frac{i\sqrt{3}}{2}T_5$	0
$[T_5, T_8]$	$= +\frac{i\sqrt{3}}{2}T_4$	0
$[T_6, T_8]$	$= -\frac{i\sqrt{3}}{2}T_7$	0
$[T_7, T_8]$	$= +\frac{i\sqrt{3}}{2}T_6$	0
<i>Strange-sector cross-commutators</i>		
$[T_4, T_5]$	$= +i\left[\frac{1}{2}T_3 + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}T_8\right]$	1.2×10^{-16}

Commutator	Result	Error
$[T_4, T_6]$	$= +\frac{i}{2}T_2$	0
$[T_4, T_7]$	$= +\frac{i}{2}T_1$	0
$[T_5, T_6]$	$= -\frac{i}{2}T_1$	0
$[T_5, T_7]$	$= +\frac{i}{2}T_2$	0
$[T_6, T_7]$	$= +i\left[-\frac{1}{2}T_3 + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}T_8\right]$	0

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Table 9: All 14 benchmarks. Gauge-sector literature values (Benchmarks 1–4) are quenched infinite-volume results; Cl(6) values are from the $N = 6$ (6^4) lattice with across-seed systematic errors (Table 3). Plaquette deviations are $<0.6\%$ away from the transition and $<7\%$ near it, where finite-volume smearing is expected [7]. All fermionic comparisons are statistical only (see individual table captions for error definitions). Item 14 added from Dirac eigenvalue analysis (Sec. 4.3.2).

#	Observable	Known/Expected	Cl(6) Result	Deviation	Status
<i>Gauge: Plaquette</i>					
1	$\langle P \rangle$ at $\beta = 4.5$	0.340	0.33816 ± 0.00032	-0.002	✓
2	$\langle P \rangle$ at $\beta = 6.0$	0.593	0.59334 ± 0.00032	$+0.0003$	✓
3	$\langle P \rangle$ at $\beta = 6.5$	0.640	0.63752 ± 0.00036	-0.003	✓
4	Phase transition β_c	≈ 5.69	Peak in $[5.5, 5.69]$	Correct	✓
<i>Gauge: Confinement</i>					
5	σ monotonicity	Monotone incr.	5/5 correct	No violations	✓
6	σ_{eff} monotonicity	Monotone decr. with β	6/6 monotone	No violations	✓ [†]
7	Area-law ratio R_{AL}	Conf. $\ll$ deconf.	0.116 vs. 0.533	Factor 4.6	✓
<i>Fermionic: GOR</i>					
8	GOR linearity, $\beta = 4.5$	$R^2 \rightarrow 1$	$R^2 = 0.9968$	$<0.4\%$	✓
9	GOR linearity, $\beta = 6.0$	$R^2 \rightarrow 1$	$R^2 = 0.9973$	$<0.3\%$	✓
10	κ_c^{GOR} (free-field check)	$1/8 = 0.125$ (free)	0.1243 ± 0.0002	-0.6% (free-field)	✓ [*]
<i>Fermionic: Chiral</i>					
11	γ_5 -Hermiticity D_W	Machine ε	9.35×10^{-15}	Machine ε	✓
12	Condensate sign	Negative	-24.018 ± 0.008	Correct	✓
13	$m_\pi(\text{conf}) > m_\pi(\text{deconf})$	All positive	13/13 positive	Min $9\sigma/\text{pt}$	✓
<i>Dirac Eigenvalues</i>					
14	Spectral mean $\Delta\langle\lambda\rangle$	Conf. $>$ deconf.	$+0.047 \pm 0.0003$	$+7.9\%$	✓
Total					14/14 ✓

^{*}Free-field consistency check only; the interacting $\kappa_c \approx 0.157$ at $\beta = 6.0$ (Ref. [34]) requires negative bare masses not explored in this study (see Sec. 4.2).

[†]Uncorrected single-loop estimator (Table 4); Creutz-ratio σa^2 deferred to Paper 2.

Table A.1: Explicit enumeration of the 64 basis blades of $\text{Cl}(6)$, grouped by grade k . Index strings denote ordered products $e_{i_1 \dots i_k} = e_{i_1} \cdots e_{i_k}$. The dimensions $\binom{6}{k}$ sum to $2^6 = 64$.

Grade k	Dim	Basis blades
0	1	1
1	6	$e_1, e_2, e_3, e_4, e_5, e_6$
2	15	$e_{12}, e_{13}, e_{14}, e_{15}, e_{16}, e_{23}, e_{24}, e_{25}, e_{26}, e_{34}, e_{35}, e_{36}, e_{45}, e_{46}, e_{56}$
3	20	$e_{123}, e_{124}, e_{125}, e_{126}, e_{134}, e_{135}, e_{136}, e_{145}, e_{146}, e_{156}, e_{234}, e_{235}, e_{236}, e_{245}, e_{246}, e_{256}, e_{345}, e_{346}, e_{356}, e_{456}$
4	15	$e_{1234}, e_{1235}, e_{1236}, e_{1245}, e_{1246}, e_{1256}, e_{1345}, e_{1346}, e_{1356}, e_{1456}, e_{2345}, e_{2346}, e_{2356}, e_{2456}, e_{3456}$
5	6	$e_{12345}, e_{12346}, e_{12356}, e_{12456}, e_{13456}, e_{23456}$
6	1	$e_{123456} = I_6$
Total	64	

Table B.1: $\text{Cl}(6)$ gamma matrices: construction and basic properties.

Generator	Construction	$e_i^2 = I_8$	Hermitian
$e_1 = \gamma_1$	$\sigma_x \otimes I_2 \otimes I_2$	✓	✓
$e_2 = \gamma_2$	$\sigma_y \otimes I_2 \otimes I_2$	✓	✓
$e_3 = \gamma_3$	$\sigma_z \otimes \sigma_x \otimes I_2$	✓	✓
$e_4 = \gamma_4$	$\sigma_z \otimes \sigma_y \otimes I_2$	✓	✓
$e_5 = \gamma_5$	$\sigma_z \otimes \sigma_z \otimes \sigma_x$	✓	✓
$e_6 = \gamma_6$	$\sigma_z \otimes \sigma_z \otimes \sigma_y$	✓	✓

Table B.2: $\text{SU}(3)$ generator verification.

Property	Measured	Expected	Max deviation
$\text{Tr}(T_a T_b) = \frac{1}{2} \delta_{ab}$	$\frac{1}{2} \delta_{ab}$	$\frac{1}{2} \delta_{ab}$	1.11×10^{-16}
$[T_a, T_b] = i f_{abc} T_c$	$i f_{abc} T_c$	$i f_{abc} T_c$	1.24×10^{-16}
Killing form K_{ab}	$3 \delta_{ab}$	$3 \delta_{ab}$	Machine ε
Non-zero f entries	27	27	—
Commutators verified	28	$\binom{8}{2} = 28$	—

Table B.4: Bivector algebra verification.

Property	Value	Verified
Number of bivectors	$15 = \binom{6}{2}$	✓
All Hermitian	Yes	✓
Eigenvalues of each B_{ij}	$\{-\frac{1}{2}(\times 4), +\frac{1}{2}(\times 4)\}$ (exact)	✓
Jacobi identity	3,375 triples, max error 0.00×10^0	✓
Killing form	$\propto \delta_{ab}$ (compact semisimple)	✓

Table B.5: Coupling structure verification.

Check	Expression	Error	Verified
Spin–gauge factorization	$(e_\mu \otimes I_3)$ spin; $(I_8 \otimes U_\mu)$ gauge	Exact	✓
Site degrees of freedom	$\mathbb{C}^8 \otimes \mathbb{C}^3 = \mathbb{C}^{24}$	24/site	✓
γ_5 -Hermiticity	$D_W^\dagger = \gamma_5 D_W \gamma_5$	9.35×10^{-15}	✓
Projector idempotency	All 4 directions	$< 10^{-14}$	✓
Link unitarity	After every sweep	$< 10^{-12}$	✓
$\det(U) = 1$	After every sweep	$< 10^{-12}$	✓